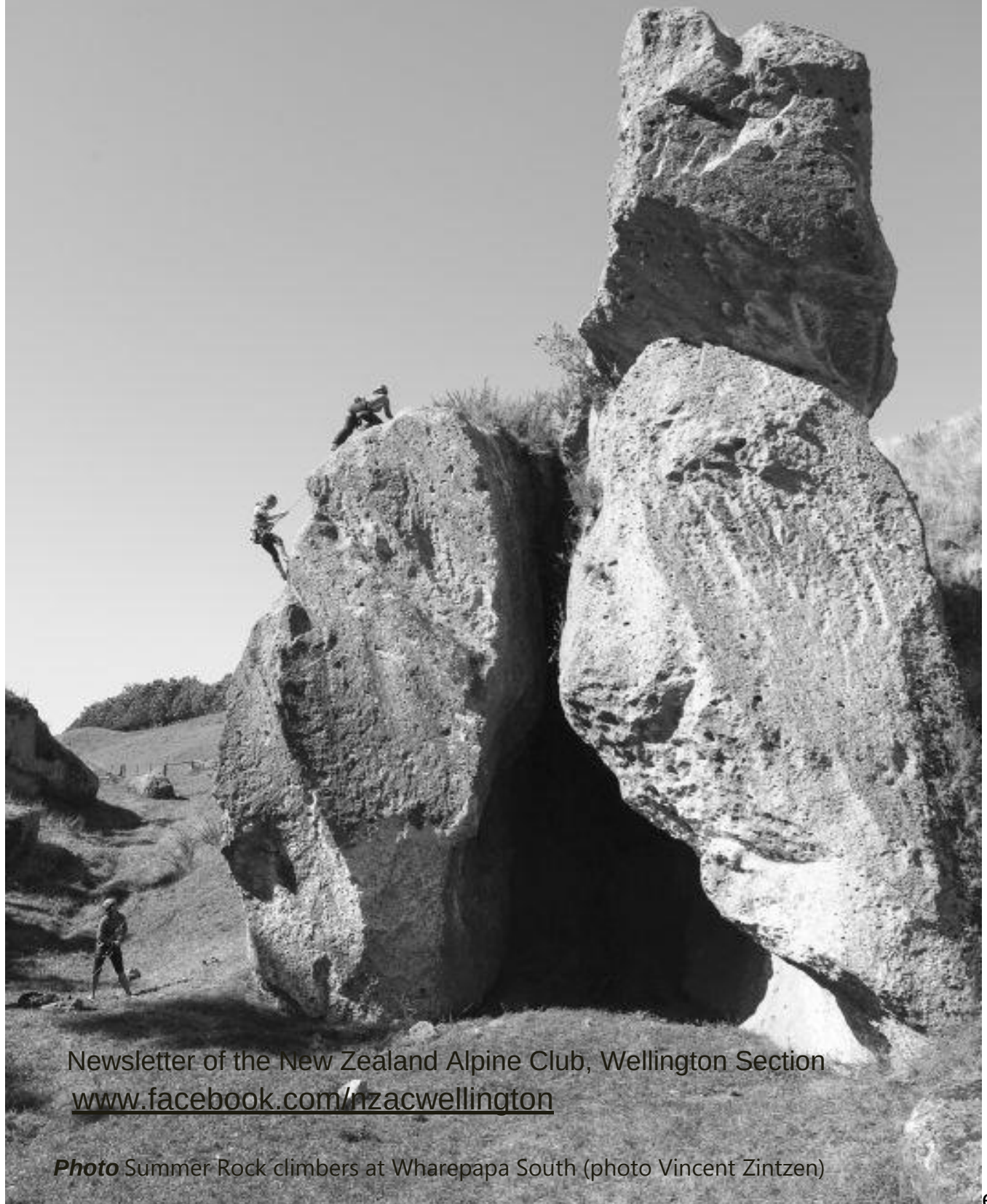


Vertigo



Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section
www.facebook.com/nzacwellington

Photo Summer Rock climbers at Wharepapa South (photo Vincent Zintzen)

Section News

April Section Night - 14 April 2014

Godzone 2014 Kaikoura - where the mountains meet the sea

New Zealand's premier Adventure Race had a strong mountain flavour again this year. The week-long event had a loop course, starting and finishing in Kaikoura with a long detour inland through scenic and wild country.

Highlights included a trek over the Tapuae-o-Uenuku saddle from the Clarence, mountain biking the Molesworth, a high ridge traverse of the Glynn Wye range, white water rafting on the Hurunui, and a dolphin-and-shark escort on the paddle back to Kaikoura.

Wellington Section was well represented with members in several teams. Take in their stories, pictures and videos from this great adventure - and start your planning for next year's race!

Drinks and nibbles from 7:45pm kick off 8:00pm

Section Nights are at the Tararua Tramping Club clubrooms, 4 Moncrieff Street, Mount Victoria, Wellington on the second Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings start 8.00 pm with tea & coffee afterwards

Trip Reports

Climbing Addicts Convention – Summer Rock 2014

Sharron Came (photos by Vincent Zintzen)

Wharepapa South

The sun glistens on the pock-marked volcanic rock towering above us as we dump our gear in the dust and cow pats and prepare to belay instructors as they head off to set up top ropes. We're on the main cliff at *Froggatt Edge* crag. I'm guessing the name is an ironic reference to that slightly more famous home to English grit stone. Situated at Wharepapa South (just south of the Tron) this Froggatt Edge is world famous in the North Island and a fitting testing ground for putting into practice everything we've learnt over the last couple of months.

A few warm up climbs complete, it's time to try out our lead climbing skills that we practised yesterday. There are tricky lines around grade 16-18 along with a few challenging 14s and 15s. Will anyone fall off *White Christmas*? Yep. Tumble down the chimney on *One Man's Meat*? Hell yes - you're supposed to stick to the arête though none of us did. Good we had a few medics amongst our party. Fall off *Monsterpiece Theatre* and *Terror Incognita*? Nah, just some carefully paced strategic rests. Today we dub Lans, the Orange Devil - resplendent as he is in bright orange trousers, a black hoodie and a bright orange helmet. Plus he spent yesterday leading Richard into temptation. As a consequence Richard's finger pads feel like they are on fire!



The day before, we warmed up on the *Slug Wall* which boasts a series of short, relatively straightforward lines broken up by a rather nasty ledge and a nastier bunch of jagged rocks at the bottom. Falling doesn't seem like a great idea. *Slug Wall* is nothing if not versatile, presenting plenty of opportunities for climbers to get some dirt under their nails and for keen gardeners or those who like dancing with spiders and other bugs the experience has its own rewards. After a bit of top roping it's time for some lead climbing.

One group heads to the *Honeycomb* but my group fancies a prominent arête. Its grade 12 but we're not precious about numbers. It's nice and exposed, sports great views and there is no ledge conveniently situated near the anchor bolts to provide a comfy position from which to figure out how to set up for an abseil. With encouragement from Shane we decide it's a great climb for applying what we've learned in the gym and at *Baring Head*. Sunscreen and vocal support are liberally shared around as we each top rope the climb then lead it. The process is scary, exhilarating and absorbing. As the sunshine starts to lose its battle with the lengthening shadows, team Arête (Shane, Robin, Emmy, James the Younger and Sharron) heads round to the main cliff where both James the Younger and James in the Hood along with Rachel and Rebecca climb a grade 16 called *Serife*, Owen and I play on a grade 10, Shane scrambles up in his jandals and Richard and the Orange Devil continue with *The Mission*.

Richard's climbed before. He is a natural athlete, wiry and fearless. Top roping and lead climbing is not going to challenge him hence the need to prepare *The Mission*. Richard must climb routes worth a total of 200 points in a day. By early evening many routes have been ticked off and Richard is still not pumped. Lans urges him on, occasionally ruling climbs out due to rests, bad form or the suspicion that he is getting a bit too close to the 200 mark. When we eventually call it quits for the day and head back to our accommodation Richard's tally stands at 180 and Lans has invented a new sport called enduro belaying.

We chill out and refuel over a superb barbecue prepared by Robin. To the surprise of nobody Richard's idea of chilling out is to spend a couple of hours in Bryce's bouldering room getting tips from a kindred spirit.

Kinloch

Our first weekend away is dominated by water. We're based at Kinloch, on the shores of Lake Taupo, the largest lake by surface area in New Zealand. Humidity is really high and it keeps raining. The rock is wet. We head to the climbing gym at Turangi where we learn the basics of lead climbing and practice setting up anchors and clipping. The café attached to the gym has great coffee providing a pleasant interlude for caffeine addicts hanging around waiting for the rock to dry. There are some great overhang climbs perfect for hanging around vertically. Lans and Vincent have a similar quiet, controlled, economical climbing style that makes hanging around look effortless. Back at Kinloch, Robin prepares a fantastic Mexican feast which some crazy runner nearly misses after getting lost on the way back from Kawakawa Bay.

Sunday is sunny and we head down to Lake Taupo and the Kinloch crag for some top rope practice. There are some easy climbs with a resting ledge half way up them – *Waiting for the Ant* and *Summer at the Beach*. We climb these, practicing our belaying as much as our climbing. People also climb *Where to From Here* and practice abseiling down and being lowered off. There is much to remember and it is a bit different putting it into practice outside on a real rock wall rather than while standing on a chair at Hang Dog. The best climb on offer is a smashing arête called *Buckets in the Belfry*. Some of us make it to the top, some of us get pumped half way up. All of us want to climb it again. Vincent, Shane and Lans give an impromptu master class in climbing technique as they climb *Electric Wizard* and *Highland Cling*. It's a pleasure to watch Scott, Gina and Catherine climb with their different styles, though belayers were, of course, concentrating on taking in and feeding out the rope. Some of us have a go at *Rockness Monster*. So many climbs, so little time. All too soon it's time to pack up and make the long drive back to Welly.



Rachel hard at work on the magnificent arete at Kinloch

Baring Head

Before our weekends away we take a day trip to *Baring Head* to try out bouldering and hopefully consolidate what we've been learning about movement on rock at Hang Dog. There is a stiff southerly but the sun is out. We have a great time clambering across rock walls trying to match techniques to the conditions – some people like slabs, others are more into chimneys. The lay backs are for those with plenty of upper body strength. Sand gets everywhere. We have a little speed climbing competition. A great day out marred only by Shjaan injuring her ankle!



Hang Dog

It all began at Hang Dog. One student, Richard, is already hanging off a wall, making use of the self-belay device to climb. Soon I'll learn the only two things I need to know about Richard. He is addicted to climbing and likes to eat cans of chilli beans. I already know Rachel and Jess because we've shared the slow, congested ride out of the city to the gym. Introductions are organised by Scott and Vincent along with a briefing on gear and knots. This is followed by some practical work around warming up and movement using the bouldering wall. We meet Mr Hang Dog himself, Ben. Later we will cover off setting up anchors and the set up for abseiling and lowering off. The process of getting to know our instructors and each other is underway. We do a few top rope climbs. We bond over the thing we have in common, varying degrees of addiction to climbing.

The Crew



Big thanks to the instructors Scott Taylor, Vincent Zintzen, Lans Hansen, Robin Maxwell, Shane Harrison, Gina Butson, Cecile Glorot, Catherine Moger and Shjaan Versey. Special thanks to Vincent for undertaking all the course administration, doing a few shirtless climbs and taking some superb photos. Robin did a fantastic job with the catering. Thanks also to my fellow students James Geary (aka James in the hood), James Skeggs (aka James the younger), Rachel Pring, Emmylou Tungol, Jess Lyon, Andrew Weaver, Richard Bell, Owen Rodda, Rebecca Hamblin and Rick Percival.



STILL ASPIRING

Paul Hill, March 2014

The years roll by and I grow old.....
What once I did with ease is harder now.
The pace of tramping has slowed.

Yet there are compensations
in this the eightieth year of my life.

My slow strides along these river flats
give time to absorb new images
to hang within the galleries of my mind.
Here, profligate, nature has flung
before the feet of a regal mountain
a mantle of glorious gold.
Raleigh's cloak could not have rivaled
the splendor of these flowering weeds.



I turn from level ground and struggle
to mount a ladder of rock and roots,
gaining height slowly – Oh, so slowly!

But, look, here is a planted garden
of fern spread beneath the canopy,
and there, cast careless on the path
a fragment of a fallen branch,
weathered to the smooth simulacrum
of a sperm whale's tooth. I leave it
for any *kai viti* who, some day,
may pass this way.

At last the forest falls back and reveals
Tititea, the Glistening Peak, glistening
in the sun and framed by leaves.

It is my reward, I ask no other.
I marvel and, content, descend.



East Face of Couloir Peak – The Big D – Feb14

Don French and Kevin Patterson

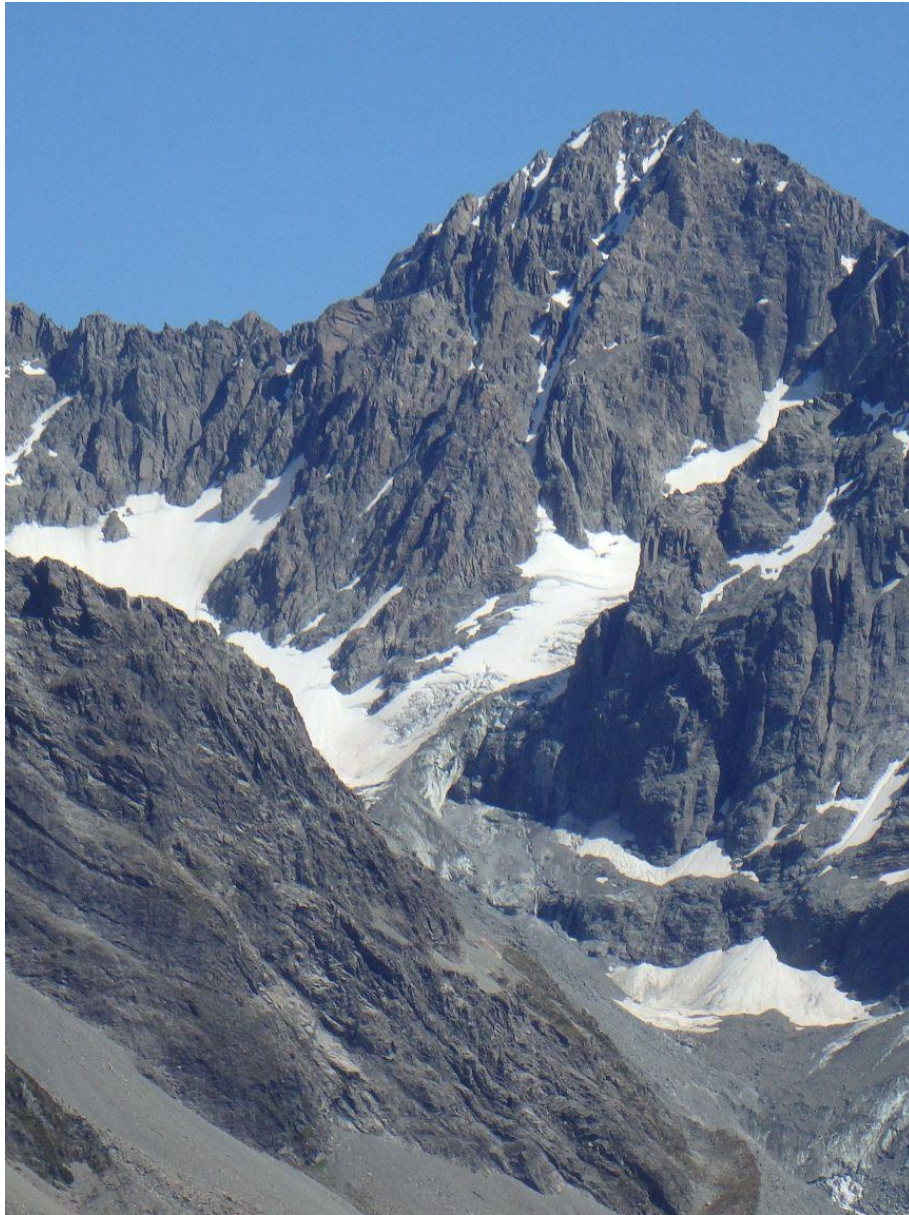
After a 2 year NZ climbing layoff I was pondering the thought of doing a few South Island climbs when DF popped up on Facebook with a climbing partner request...a new route in the Arrowsmiths...who could turn down an opportunity like that?!

I had been somewhat apprehensive about spending time/money climbing in NZ – the logistical challenges are a nightmare. Usually it's only fine 1 in 3 or 4 days in NZ. Often a minimum 3 days is required to climb most South Island peaks, so you may wait a frustrating/boring week or more for the weather to be right. Usually a hard 8-10 hours up river valleys is required just to get to the base of the mountain, along rough tracks if they exist, often bush bashing as there is no track at all. Then having to cross fast moving, cold, thigh deep rivers. On the summit day you won't get any change out of 12 hours. Often 15-20 hours is the norm. Then on the third day you have to repeat the first day in reverse. All the time hoping that your 3 day weather window isn't a 1 day one. So much effort for so little reward.

Compare that to Europe where easy cable car access and more stable weather patterns means that you can often climb 2 summits in a day, i.e. achieve around 10 times more summits for the same effort. Often on much higher quality rock/ice. In the USA where the weather is super stable you can achieve 20 times more summits.

Anyway, like most of us, I'm in NZ at present and therefore have to make the best of what is on offer. And we do have a remote wildness to our alpine climbing that is difficult to match in a very overcrowded Europe.

So the peak we were going to climb is Couloir Peak in the Arrowsmiths, accessible by the standard route up to Cameron Hut (1300m). This isn't too bad for access, around 7-9h up the Cameron River, no river crossings, a bit of a trail to follow, some prickly Matagouri to push through. Don thoughtfully pushed ahead and did some Matagouri gardening with his pruning saw. "Hey DF, don't you need a resource permit to do that!" What a good chap, even though he got constantly punctured he persisted in the track upgrade – should bring some gardening gloves for him next time.



Loaded down with 23kg packs, we took a leisurely 2 days to get to the hut...visions of Blackadders world discovery expedition getting stuck for 6 months in Southampton anyone?...“If we take any longer we’ll run out of water”. “Well actually we ran out of water 2 months ago”. “What have we been drinking then?”. But what a walk, stunning mountainous scenery and wild tussock lands that got better and better as we went further, alongside a fast flowing river that we didn’t have to cross.

Our secret was in the timing, because the third day looked like it would have a bit of weather so we declared it a ‘take it easy’ day with a plan to get to a high bivvy late in that day. Basically “You can’t schedule the weather!”

Right on schedule day 3 was a wet weather day. Even our planned late afternoon bivvy up high couldn’t happen. So we decided on one big single day push with a 5am start and within 3 hours we’re watching the sun come up while at the confluence of the two glaciers which make up the Cameron Glacier at 1700m

We do a left turn and start up the South Cameron Glacier then at 2000m head right up a branch that heads steeply up to the left of our objective - Couloir Peak. At this point for about

50m I'm wishing I had a second tool on the harder ice, but the slope soon eases off, and we zig-zag easily between the slots.

Our initial objective, the full south ridge, comes into profile. This is quickly discarded when a considerable overhang is viewed 50m below the top. So we head instead for a direct climb up the east face. By 10am we are at the base of the pyramid and ready to rock and roll.



And it looked formidable – 350m of near vertical face with no clear overall route – just a mix of possibilities each of which would have to be negotiated as we tease our way to the top. Don opened the batting for the first pitch on what proved to be the crux (16) – a nasty looking overhanging corner about 20m up along a crack line. Despite the second carrying most of the gear, the crux proved too much on thin crimps and the leaders pack was left attached so the moves could be made.



I lead the second pitch which was slightly easier although further progression upwards still looked formidable. On the third pitch Don's intuition cut in and we traversed right out of this crack line around an arête and up slabs to easier ground. The fourth pitch was easier still but we were running out of time – 1pm and we were barely 100m up with 250m to go – we looked like we were to join the alpine honours list, i.e. to be be-knighted.

We briefly debated rappelling off down to the glacier below, but decided to push on. Things moved pretty quickly after that, but not without a bit of a scare with some loose rock on pitch 6 – pretty much a 20m solo. For the next 4 pitches it was a breeze with the last 2 pitches being simul-climbed.

A 100m summit traverse past a gendarme saw us summiting Couloir Peak (2642m) at 5pm. Looks like we may be able to get back to the hut tonight. But our day was well short of being done. We needed to traverse the ridge, rap into a snowfield then traverse a further ridge (point 2474) to reach Cameron Col 1km away – this took 3h. However the weather was stunning – blue skies, no wind, big views down into and past the Lawrence valley, the alps stretching out into an arc in the distance – just like climbing in the Cascades in America!

Once at Cameron Col (2427m) a long steep downclimb on the glacier is required – this is tedious but must be approached with a discipline that can allow no mistakes – one slip on the ice here would result in a 500m slide with serious injury. By 10pm we are at the glacier confluence (1700m) and on the home run just as it goes dark.

After a little night time confusion descending the icefall route we were safely back at the hut by midnight – a 19h day all up and a great first ascent.

The Big D – Topo – direct route on East Face of Couloir Peak (2642m)

From Cameron Hut, allow 5h for the approach, 7h for the climb, and 7h for the descent back to the hut.

Approach – Up Cameron Glacier past icefall to glacier confluence (1700m). Turn left, ascend to 1950m. Then take a right up a steep (50 degree) ice slope to eventually arrive at the base of a prominent corner directly below the summit (2300m). Start 10m right of the main corner.

Pitch 1 (40m, 16) – up crack until under roof (20m). Turn the roof by traversing left onto the face (crux). Ascend slabs to belay ledge. Good rock.

Pitch 2 (15m, 15) – up corner to belay ledge

Pitch 3 (40m, 14) - traverse right out of crack and around arête for 10m. Then up a series of ledges on quality rock

Pitch 4 (40m, 12) – follow cracks up to large ledge

Pitch 5 (35m, 10) – down right into gravel, then ascend loose easy ledges arriving at a red corner.

Pitch 6 (20m, 12) – right and up to top ledge up crumbly, difficult to protect, rock. Scary pitch.

Pitch 7 (30m, 15) - traverse left past red corner then up fissure past detached pillar and around corner

Pitch 8 (45m, 12) – traverse 10m left then directly up. Follow a series of cracks to wide ledge.

Pitch 9 (100m, 10) – Easy scramble up and right. Simul-climb this pitch taking care rope drag doesn't drop loose rock on partner below.

Pitch 10 (100m, 10) – Easy scramble.

From the summit ridge it is a further 100m traverse past a f gendarme to the summit (2642m).

Descent – continue traversing 100m along summit ridge to the SW until at small col above a steep snow/ice couloir on the TL. Descend this steep at first (a rap may be required) for 250m (vertical) to a wide snowfield. Continue along this 600m to the right staying to the west of the ridge on easy ground, crossing point 2474, and eventually arriving at Cameron Col (2427m). Cross the Col and traverse a further 200m due south across the glacier and then carefully turn to descend 700m of steep snow/ice to arrive back at the glacier confluence (1700m).

Notices

Revised Hut Log Book Storage Locality Index

Bill Keir has just revised his Hut Log Book Index. It is available as a PDF on the NZ Alpine Club website: <https://alpineclub.org.nz/heritage/archives>

The New Zealand Alpine Club request that should you find one of our hut logs to be full, please return it to Margaret at the National Office, PO Box 786, Christchurch 8140 so she can index it for storage and supply the hut with a new log book.

FMC Part-time Positions

Administrator Position

The person filling this role will provide secretariat services and administrative support to the Federation.

The position is 0.5 FTE but is not spread evenly across the year. At times it will require 3-5 hours per day and for other periods it may only require 4 hours in a week.

The position is based in Wellington but the Administrator is expected to attend quarterly FMC Executive meetings and the FMC Annual General Meeting which are sometimes outside of Wellington.

Financial Controller Position

The person filling this role will provide the principal financial control and oversight for the efficient and effective running of Federated Mountain Clubs.

The position involves 4 days averaged over a month. The workload is uneven and, at times, it will require 3 to 5 hours a day and for other periods it may require only minimal time.

A strong preference is for the position to be based in Wellington but could be based at any location in New Zealand with good broadband access. The Financial Controller is expected to attend the Federation's Annual General Meeting and FMC Executive meetings to present the draft financial reports and budget.

Further Information and Applications

For further information and job descriptions contact the FMC office or Owen Cox (outside of work hours).

FMC Office – Tuesday and Thursdays – 04 385 9516, email admin@fmc.org.nz or PO Box 1604, Wellington, 6140.

Owen Cox – evenings only – 04 905 8094, email owencox@paradise.net.nz

Applications to PO Box 1604, Wellington, 6140 by Wednesday 16 April 2014.

Tukino Lodge – Working Party Volunteers Needed

Tukino Lodge - work party volunteers required. All types of helpers are required for various tasks that need to be completed prior to winter. For details on the work that needs to be done and the date please see <https://alpineclub.org.nz/news/2014/working-bees-at-tukino-lodge-volunteers-required>. Please contact Don French H: 06 377 7117 or M: 027 445

2980 Email: don@french.net.nz

Alpine Club Calendars – special price of \$5 for the last few calendars

There are about a dozen 2014 calendars left and they're being sold for \$5 + postage. <https://alpineclub.org.nz/product/nzac-alpine-calendar-2014-current-issue-on-sale>

New benefit for members – Craig Potton Publishing

As new publications are released, specific titles will be made available to NZAC members at a 20% discount. The current offer and time limit to redeem the offer are detailed below.

Information on the books' content may be found in the attached PDFs:

Current Applicable titles:

- New Zealand Whitewater ISBN 9780473260941 RRP \$34.99
- Above the Treeline ISBN 9781877517761 RRP \$49.99

Discount and discount code:-

- 20% off RRP by quoting Discount Code (obtained from [Margaret](#), or [Narina](#))
- Free Freight within New Zealand

Dates available:

- 1st March 2014 until 30th June 2014

Link to the Craig Potton Publishing website:-

- <http://www.craigpotton.co.nz/>

Darrans Winter Climbing Meet

Date: 2013-07-12 (All day) - 2013-07-21 (All day)

Location: Homer Hut

Organiser: Alistair Walker - mealluaine@yrless.co.nz

Section: [Southland Section](#)



The Darrans Winter Climbing Meet has been a growing success story- it has introduced many alpinists to the thrills and risks of winter climbing. Last year a bunch of new routes were established. Al Walker has scheduled this year meet from the 12th-21st of July. See forum discussion: <http://climber.co.nz/forum/events/darrans-winter-climbing-meet-2014>

A regular and popular fixture in the NZAC calendar, the Southland Section is again organising their annual Winter Climbing Meet, based, as always, at the Homer Hut, in the Darran Mountains.

Open to all, this year The Meet is running from July 11th until July 20th. Registration of interest sooner rather than later would be appreciated. There is a practical limit to the number of people the hut, its facilities, and the immediate environment can handle in Winter. For this reason, camping beside the hut is not an option during The Meet. When we ask for confirmation closer to the time, space will be allocated on a first come first served basis. Please note that The Meet is not really suited to those with no Winter experience. If in doubt, contact Al by e-mail (above).

The Meet provides an informal and sociable venue where climbers can get together, meet with new partners, perhaps climb in an area they have never visited, and exchange views and ideas on technique and ethics. You don't need a climbing partner to come along, no-one has ever had any trouble hooking up with one when down there. Don't come expecting to climb only on ice. The Darrans is better for Scottish style mixed, and can be both technical and serious, but best be mentally prepared for anything. Winter climbing in The Darrans is still young, but is on a par with the best on offer anywhere.

Going to the Homer Hut is a natural choice, apart from being right beside the road, big and reasonably comfortable. The Darrans has it all, "roadside" crags 300m high, huge unclimbed faces as big as anything else in New Zealand, peaks waiting a First Winter Ascent, what more could a climber ask! Apart from the myriad of potential new routes, the established climbs are generally proving to be well worthwhile as well.

Daylight is a bit limited in July, but the weather is often better. Conditions on the cliffs may be a bit less snowy, but will always be "interesting". No matter what though, there always seems to be a fair bit of climbing gets done, with the odd new route thrown in.

If you're considering coming, you do need to be aware that the Darrans in Winter can be a gnarly place, and you might have to wait out bad weather. The road can be blocked by avalanches. Bear in mind also, that there is no nearby rescue team. Essentially, you take have to take responsibility for yourself. But don't let any of that put you off, it's still the best Winter climbing venue in the country.

Remarkables Ice and Mixed festival 14 – 17 August 2014

SO WHATS THIS FESTIVAL ALL ABOUT?

- Bringing together a huge cross section of climbers from around NZ and the world.
- Beginners get to rub shoulders and share the rope with the top winter alpine climbers in NZ.
- Clinics, competitions, races and social gatherings advance and promote modern mixed climbing.
- Showcasing the new and existing route potential on NZ's most accessible multi pitch winter training area The Remarkables.
- Sharing local knowledge and forming new climbing partnerships.
- Fundraising for the NZAC expedition fund.

There are limited places available on the clinics and discounts available for NZAC members so be quick to secure your place. Full details on the festival can be found at

<http://www.iceandmixedfestival.co.nz/#>

Expedition Capital Fund – supporters thank you

Thank you to our three corporate supporters of the NZAC Expedition Capital Fund for their donations to date.



We encourage members to continue supporting these companies to help us grow this fund for the Expeditions of the future.

<https://alpineclub.org.nz/donation/expedition-capital-fund>

Wellington Section 2012/13 contacts list

We are always thankful for volunteers and members stepping forward to help the section run smoothly. If you'd like to learn more about how you could get involved, please email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz

Position	Name	Email alias*	Contact
Chairperson	Dan Pringle	chairperson	027 768-2185
Vice Chair	Vincent Zintzen	vicechair	
Secretary	Julian Davidson	secretary or CM2	
Treasurer	Adam Newberry	treasurer	
National Rep	Dan Pringle		
Patron	John Nankervis		
Trips	Vacant	Trips	
Other Committee Members	Simon Williamson		
	John Yu		
	Sharran Came		
Other Roles:			
Gear	vacant	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	vacant	PLB	
Instruction Coordinator	vacant		
Instruction - AIC	vacant		
Instruction - Rock	vacant		
Library	Joke Meerkens	library	
Newsletter Editor	Carolyn Ellis		Kaz1963@gmail.com
Rock Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	John Yu	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
03 3777 595	National Executive Officer	Sam Newton	sam@alpineclub.org.nz



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* to be precise, this is just an average but we do aim for new routes every single week.



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